



Even Keel

The December 2026 CEA link — the proposal in ten minutes

For managers · 26 weeks · code EK-26-H1 · the full proposal sheet has the detail

The short version

Four numbers

9 of 9

**December rules
met**

today's link: 4

35h

**contracted hours
a week**

rostered exactly,
Mon–Sat average

0

**avoidable
fatigue warnings**

in the fixed rota ·
today 4

26

**people on the
link**

today: 20

Every December rule met — and no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

The staffing you asked for

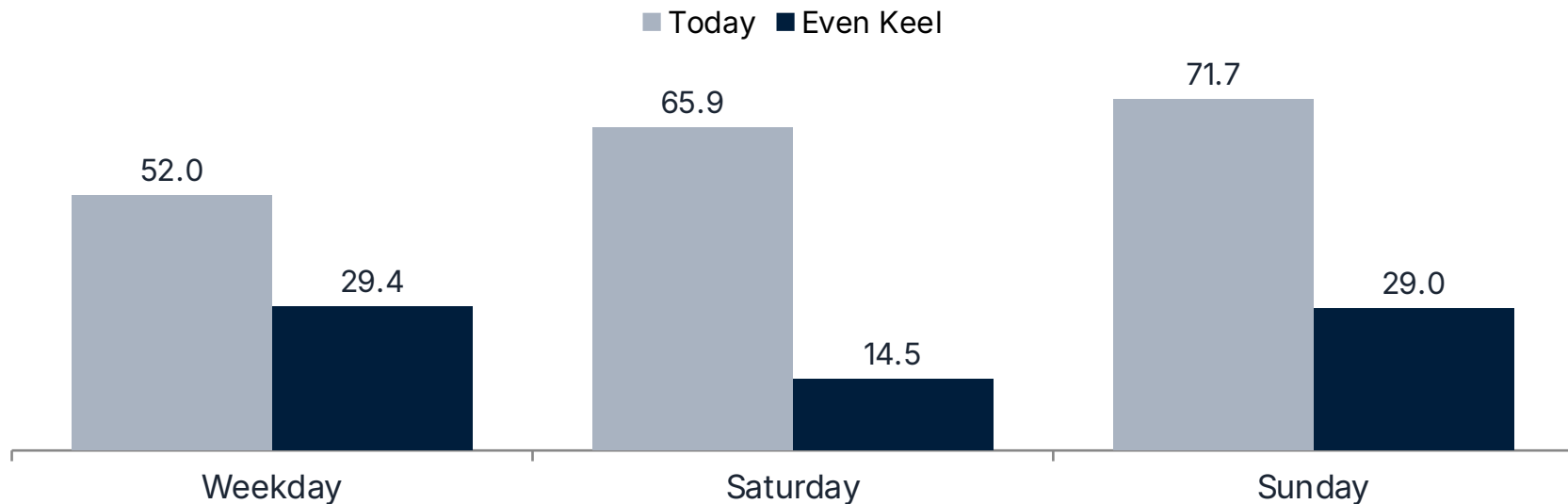
Weekday · Saturday · Sunday

	Today	Even Keel
On duty during the day	11-12 · 10 · 8	15 · 14 · 10
At the open (06:20, Sunday 07:15)	4 · 4 · 3	5 · 5 · 4
Still on after 22:00	4 · 2 · 3	7 · 5 · 5
Through to the close	2 · 2 · 3	3 · 4 · 3
Fewest rostered on the floor	2 · 2 · 2	3 · 3 · 3

Every level met on every day — and the ticket office staffed in pairs, including Sundays.

People where the trains are

How far the floor staffing is from the shape of the December timetable — lower is better



Much closer to the December pattern every day. The score: hour by hour, how far staffing sits from the trains; 0 would track them exactly.

People and hours

What it takes to run

	Today	Even Keel
People on the link	20	26
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Cover weeks (for leave and sickness)	4 in 20 (1 in 5)	5 in 26 (1 in 5.2)
People needed each Sunday (overtime)	8	10

Six more people, 35 hours a week on average; Sunday overtime 83h 30m a week across the link (today 68h 15m).

Fatigue checks

Against the Office of Rail and Road's good-practice list and the rail industry's own checks

	Today	Even Keel
Avoidable fatigue warnings, fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	0
Most days in a row (limit 13)	7 (up to 9)	5 (up to 6)
Shortest rest between shifts (limit 12h)	12h 30m	14h 35m
Longest shift	9h 10m	9h 00m

Rest and run limits met with room to spare; no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

Why Even Keel?

What all three shortlisted links give, what this one adds, and what it costs

- ✓ All three shortlisted: all 9 December rules and the 3 flexible ones; no fatigue warning
- ✓ All three shortlisted: about 14 full weekends off a year (today 10), at most 5 apart
- ✓ All three shortlisted: no shift over 9 hours, and every closing shift shorter
- ✓ This one adds: no week over 41h 30m, and at least 14h 35m between shifts
- ✓ 8 of 15 shift times worked today; 7 new, several shorter versions of today's lates
- Costs: 44 late finishes a year (today 39), a mixed week, four weeks off 15 days not 14

Late finishes: 44 a year each (today 39) — two above the rules' minimum, buying a fourth person to the Saturday close. The colleague deck shows every cost openly.

What colleagues will notice

The good and the not so good — the colleague presentation shows both

Likely to welcome

- 14 full weekends off a year (today 10), at most 5 apart
- One shift time in 18 of 21 weeks (today 7 of 16)
- At most 5 days in a row on the fixed rota (today 7)
- No week over 41h 30m Monday to Saturday
- Shortest rest 14h 35m (today 12h 30m)

Likely to worry about

- Late finishes: 44 a year (today 39)
- 7 new shift times to learn, 2 on a Saturday
- Average shift about 2 minutes longer
- Best 14-day leave stretch 28 days, not 30
- Four weeks off takes 15 days' leave at best, not 14

Expect late finishes to be the first question — the colleague deck answers it openly.

Where it stands

Three things confirmed verbally, two decisions left, two points still open



December rules — confirmed

The nine December rules. Everything here is built on them.



26 people on the link — confirmed

Six more than today, with five cover weeks.



Sunday cover — confirmed

Ten on a Sunday — Sunday work stays overtime.



To decide: which link we use

Colleagues' views come first.



Then: who starts on which line

Who begins on which week. Open: the 13-day limit's written source; the FF19 reading.



The detail

- Every week of the link, day by day
- Staff on duty hour by hour, against the trains
- Every December rule and fatigue check, worked through

All in the eight-page proposal sheet · Even Keel · EK-26-H1